inflation, lack of employment opportunities and issues pertaining to security and violence. Most importantly the youth reported very low confidence in the official institutions, in particular the government, parliament and political parties. According to the BC research 71 per cent of the young respondents rated the national government unfavourably, 67 per cent rated the National Assembly unfavourably and 69 per cent rated political parties unfavourably.[37]

In July 2018, with upcoming elections, the Institute of Development and Economic Alternatives (IDEAS) undertook a political attitudes survey in Lahore that included a total sample of 2,127 respondents from 'four provincial assembly constituencies (PP 146, 147, 148 and 149)[38] in three national assembly constituencies' (NA 121, 122 and 124).[39] 'Close to two-thirds' of the participants indicated 'purchasing power or kuwat-e-kharid', that is, economic issues, as the most important concern, followed by one-third who were concerned about unemployment, and a little more than one-third concerned about corruption (Cheema and Liaqat 2017, p. 4). While this survey cannot be generalized to the whole of Pakistan, let alone Punjab or even Lahore, it does highlight issues that took centre stage in the previous elections as well.

Rights and responsibilities

In examining the meaning of the state–citizen relationship for young Pakistanis, the participants were also asked their opinion about rights and responsibilities. In 2009, the responses highlighted that none of the young adults thought that the basic tenets of the social contract were functioning. *'The concept of citizenship in Pakistan is not according to what it should be. A citizen is not receiving his rights and duties the way it should be. Unemployment is at the peak and educated young ones are irritated with it'* (Teacher, Female, Faisalabad); '*I believe there is a great difference between the concept and implementation of citizenship. Citizens in Pakistan have rights but hardly any of them are available to us*' (Teacher, Female, Karachi); '*In Pakistan there is no concept of citizenship. People do not know about their rights as citizens, they are being exploited by people who are supposed to serve them as public servants. For example, if you are an ordinary man, you can not dare get your FIR*[40] *registered in a police station*' (Academic, Male, Lahore). The 'ordinary man', normally from a less privileged background, would not have the same rights as the rich. However, even young educated Pakistanis in private and government universities expressed their lack of knowledge about their rights as citizens, while for others citizenship and the rights that followed seemed